A1 - Short-Answer Paper

75 minutes, ten short-answer questions, sat in Moodle in class, closed book

IT8204 Blockchain and Cryptocurrency | 20 percent of the course | CILO 1(primary) and 2 | v4.2

How to use this brief. You sit Assessment 1 entirely in Moodle: the questions appear on screen and you type your answers there, so there is nothing to print and nothing to bring. This brief tells you what the paper covers, how the ten questions are chosen, how long you have, and how your answers are marked. Section 3 lists the ten topics you will be examined on. Treat that list as your revision plan: one question comes from each topic, so every topic is worth preparing.

This brief replaces every earlier version of the A1 brief. Read this one.

1. At a glance

Item	Detail
What A1 is	One quiz, sat once, in Moodle, with invigilator in the room.
How long	75 minutes.
How many questions	Ten. Every question is a short-answer question: you type your own answer in a box. There are no multiple-choice questions.
What it covers	Teaching weeks 1 to 6 only. Nothing from Week 7 onwards is in it. Section 2 explains why, and section 3 names the ten topics.
Where the questions come from	The short-answer questions in your Week 1 to Week 6 worksheets. Nothing in the quiz comes from outside those worksheets.
How the ten are chosen	One question is set on each of the ten topics listed in section 3, so you are examined on all ten topics, one question each. Moodle chooses the question for each topic at random, so two students sitting side by side may be answering different questions on the same ten topics.
How it is marked	Every answer is read and marked by a tutor against a model answer. Nothing is marked by the computer. Each answer is scored from 0 to 5, so ten questions give a total out of 50, and your percentage is that total doubled. Section 4 works this through.
Conditions	Closed book. No notes, books, phones, smart watches or other devices. Supervised.
What you hand in	Nothing. You type your answers into Moodle and Moodle saves them. There is no file to upload and no cover sheet to fill in. A1 is the only assessment on this course that works this way; A2, A3 and A4 all have something you hand in.
Weight	20 percent of the course mark. That is one fifth of your final result.
What it evidences	Course intended learning outcomes (CILO 1 and 2) are the primary outcome evidenced here: reading blockchain mechanics and use cases well enough to make a business judgement.

When	The assessment week beginning 1 November 2026. To be confirmed: the exact day, start time and room are set by the Course Coordinator and published on Moodle at least two weeks before the sit.
To submit	Nothing separately. You finish the quiz in Moodle and your answers are recorded when you submit the attempt.
Pass	The course is passed on the overall course mark: 60 percent overall, with no separate must-pass component. No single assessment has to be passed on its own.
Resit	Capped at 60 percent under the BP Assessment Regulations.
If you are ill or affected	Use the Special Assessment Considerations route within three working days of the sit.

2. What A1 covers: teaching weeks 1 to 6 only

A1 examines the first six teaching weeks of the course and nothing after them. That is not a choice anyone made about the syllabus. It is forced by the calendar, and the calendar is worth setting out plainly, because it is the reason you can revise for this paper with confidence.

- Teaching weeks 1 to 6 finish on Friday 23 October 2026. By that date you have completed twelve worksheets, two in each of those six weeks.
- A1 is sat in the assessment week beginning 1 November 2026. That is the mid-semester assessment week, and it comes immediately after the mid-semester break.
- Teaching week 7 does not begin until 8 November 2026, which is after the sit.

Put those three dates together and the conclusion follows on its own. On the day you sit A1, weeks 7 to 12 have not been taught. A paper that drew on them would be asking you about material you had never seen. So every question on the paper comes from weeks 1 to 6, from a worksheet you have already completed.

What this means for your revision: revise weeks 1 to 6. Do not spend time on weeks 7 to 12 for this paper. They are examined elsewhere, through your weekly worksheets (A2), the group business case (A3) and the written defence (A4).

3. The ten topics you will be examined on

When you start the quiz, Moodle chooses one question at random on each of the ten topics below. So you answer ten questions, one on each topic, and every student is examined on the same ten topics. Which particular question you get on a topic varies from student to student.

This is why revising one favourite topic deeply will not carry you, and why there is no topic you can safely skip: each one is worth one question out of ten, which is 10 percent of your A1 mark.

Topic	The sessions it comes from
The two costs and the FinTech ecosystem	Week 1, Session 1

Reading a transaction on a public chain	Week 1, Session 2
How a blockchain produces integrity	Week 2, Session 1
Permissioned and permissionless ledgers, and consensus	Week 2, Session 2
Crypto market structure and wallet types	Week 3, Session 1
Custody policy, and the mining energy debate	Week 3, Session 2
Smart contracts and the oracle problem	Week 4, Session 1
Choosing a chain	Week 4, Session 2
Bahrain's Crypto-asset Rulebook	Week 5
Bahrain's data protection law, and ethics	Week 6

Each row of that table is one question on your paper. Find those sessions in your own folder, open the worksheets you completed in them, and work through your own answers again.

4. What a short-answer question looks like

A short-answer question asks for a specific answer in your own words, usually one to four sentences, or a short list. It is not an essay and it is not a tick-box. You are asked for the thing itself, not for a discussion of it.

- It asks for something exact: a named rule, a named body, a mechanism, a risk, a consequence, a comparison in one line.
- It is answerable from the worksheets. Nothing in the quiz needs a source you have not already used in class.
- Nothing is keyed to a figure that moves, such as a live price or a today-only percentage.

5. How A1 is marked

Every answer is read and marked by a tutor against a model answer. Nothing on this paper is marked by the computer. The computer's only job is to show you the ten questions and store what you type.

That matters for how you write. Because a person reads your answer, you are not trying to guess an exact form of words that a machine will accept. Write the idea accurately and specifically, in your own words, and it will be credited.

The arithmetic is the course's usual 0 to 5 marking scale, applied ten times. Here it is step by step, so there is no mystery in your result.

- Each of your ten answers is scored from 0 to 5, using the anchors in the table below. Half marks are used, so 3.5 is a real score.
- Ten answers scored out of 5 give a paper total out of 50 marks.

- Your A1 percentage is that total doubled. A total of 30 out of 50 is 60 percent; a total of 40 out of 50 is 80 percent; a total of 50 out of 50 is 100 percent.
- Doubling is simply what converts a mark out of 50 into a mark out of 100. It is the same as scoring each answer out of 5, multiplying by 20 to get that answer's percentage, and averaging the ten.

So 3.0 out of 5 on every answer gives 30 out of 50, which is 60 percent, which is the pass point on this paper.

Score	What an answer at this level looks like
5.0 Excellent (100 percent)	Exactly right, specific, and in your own words. Nothing important is missing and nothing is padded.
4.0 Very Good (80 percent)	Right and specific, but one part is thin or approximate.
3.5 Credit (70 percent)	Mostly right and relevant; the answer is partly general.
3.0 Pass (60 percent)	On topic and broadly right, but general, or one required part is missing.
2.0 or below Fail (below 60 percent)	Missing, off topic, or substantially wrong.

Grades follow the BP A+ to F scale (BP Academic Regulations 2.0, clause 4.3). A borderline result of 57 to 59 percent is reviewed by the Lecturer and the Internal Moderator.

6. How to prepare

- Revise weeks 1 to 6, and only weeks 1 to 6. Section 2 explains why nothing later is examined here.
- Work through your own Week 1 to Week 6 worksheets again, with your notes closed. Every question on the paper came from one of them, so that is the single most useful hour of revision you can spend.
- Cover all ten topics in section 3. Each topic is one question, so each is worth 10 percent of your A1 mark, and no topic can be skipped.
- Practise writing short. A good answer here is two or three precise sentences. Long answers do not score more, and they cost you time you need for the other nine questions.
- Watch the clock. Ten questions in 75 minutes is about seven minutes each, which leaves time to read the paper at the start and check your answers at the end. If one question stalls you, move on and come back.

7. Rules and conduct

- Closed book: no notes, books, printed material, phones, smart watches, or any other device.
- Supervised: a member of staff is in the room for the whole sit. Bring your BP student identification card.

- Registered adjustments, for example extra time, are arranged by the Course Coordinator before the sit. Tell the Coordinator in good time.
- Bringing prohibited material or a device into the room is treated as academic misconduct under BP Assessment Policy A-AB-005.

8. Alignment and fairness

Requirement	How A1 meets it
Measures CILO 1 and 2	Every question tests the mechanics and use-case reading taught in teaching weeks 1 to 6.
Nothing untaught	The paper covers weeks 1 to 6 only, because weeks 7 to 12 have not been taught on the day of the sit.
Nothing unseen	Every question is taken from a worksheet you have already completed. There is no hidden material.
Fair breadth	One question is drawn from each of the ten topic categories, so no student is advantaged or disadvantaged by which topic came up.
Consistent marking	Every answer is marked by a tutor against the same model answer and the same 0 to 5 anchors, whichever question in a topic a student was given.
Fair for learners writing in a second language	Short written answers, marked for accuracy and reasoning rather than for fluent English. Registered extra-time adjustments apply.
Durable	No question depends on a figure that changes over time.

9. Sources and policies

- Grading: BP Academic Regulations 2.0, clause 4.3 (A+ to F; pass at 60 percent).
- Integrity: BP Assessment Policy A-AB-005 V2.
- Marking standard: IT8204 A1 Marking Criteria and Exemplar v1.docx, in the Assessment criteria and exemplars folder in Moodle, which shows how each answer is scored and gives a worked exemplar.